Phoenix United Basketball Development Club

TEAM COACH GUIDE

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CONTENTS

Purpose 3

Introduction 3

Pre-Season 3

- BBA Rules 3
- PlayHQ 4
- Team Planning 4
- Player Goal Setting 4
- Team Communication 4
- Equipment 4

Training 4

- Plan Trainings 4
- Attendance 5
- Time Management 5
- Player Development 5

Game Day 5

- Pre-Game 5
- During the Game 5
- Post-Game 5
- My Hoops 5

Communication 6

- Parent/Guardians Meetings 6
- Regular Updates 6
- Feedback 6

Player Development and Motivation 6

- Individual Attention 6
- Positive Reinforcement 6
- Mental Toughness and Resilience 6
- Tournaments 7

Managing Difficult Situations 7

- Player Issues 7
- Parent/Guardian Concerns 7
- Injury Management 7

End of Season Responsibilities 7

Team Wrap-Up 7
Player Recognition 7
Feedback and Reflection 8
Club 8
Initiatives 8
Resources 8
Compliance 8
Club Rules & Policies 8
Feedback 8
Conclusion 9

PURPOSE

The purpose of this guide is to assist volunteer Team Coaches at Phoenix carry out their duties as a Team Coach. Please remember, your committee is always here to provide guidance and support. We also welcome your feedback as we work together, as volunteers, to deliver the best experience for our junior players and their families.

This guide is being implemented for the 1st time, and we greatly appreciate any feedback on how we can make it better. Please send to hello@bendigophoenix.org.au.

INTRODUCTION

As a Team Coach, you play a pivotal role in shaping the development of our players both on and off the court. This guide will help you navigate your responsibilities, ensuring a successful and enjoyable season for both you and your team.

This is your team - you and your Team Manager know what will work best. This guide is simply here to support you along the way.

PRE-SEASON

BBA Rules

- Read and become familiar with BBA rules and policies. You can start with the following:
    - Basic BBA Bylaw Rules for Beginners
    - BBA Domestic Competition Polices & Guidelines

    - Browse the BBA website.
- The Club has also created a Team Coach Rules Cheat Sheet here.

PlayHQ

- Register as a Coach in PlayHQ by following this PlayHQ guide.
- Once allocated as Coach to a team you have access to that team in PlayHQ – navigate to the My Teams section and follow this PlayHQ guide.

Team Planning

- Work with your Team Manager to ensure all players are registered and ready for the season.
- Set clear goals and expectations for the team and communicate these to both players and parents/guardians.
- Plan your season's training sessions based on the players' skill levels and objectives for the year.

Player Goal Setting

- Encourage parents/guardians to draft their player's goal for the season in the Player Journal using the SMART Goals Guide located in the policies section of the Club's website.
- Finalise each player's goals with them in the Player Journal.
- Check in mid-season and again at end of season updating the Player Journal with the player.

Team Communication

- Use the team communication channel established by the Team Manager to communicate with players and parents/guardians.
- Share key information about practice schedules, game times, and any other important updates.

Equipment

- Check your Coach Kit inventory is fully stocked (e.g., basketballs, cones, first aid kit). If any items are missing, contact the Committee for replenishment.
- With the Team Manager ensure players have the correct uniforms and are aware of the team's uniform policy ie. Are you wearing purple or BBA compliant black shorts ie. No pockets.

TRAINING

Plan Trainings

- Structure training to focus on skill development, team play, and fitness. Always include time for both individual and team drills.

- Rotate drills to keep practices engaging and ensure all areas of the game are covered (offense, defense, shooting, etc.).
- Incorporate fun and teamwork to build morale and keep players excited about improving.

Attendance

- Keep track of player attendance and notify the Team Manager if there are any attendance issues or concerns.
- Encourage players to communicate if they can't attend practice, so you can plan accordingly.

Time Management

- Start and end practices on time to show respect for everyone's schedule.
- Ensure that practices are dynamic, with minimal downtime, so players stay engaged and focused.

Player Development

- Focus on developing the players' individual skills, understanding of the game, and team dynamics.
- Provide constructive feedback, ensuring players know what they're doing well and where they can improve.

GAME DAY

Pre-Game

- Confirm game details, including location, time, and opponent, with the Team Manager.
- Ensure players arrive on time and are prepared (uniforms, water, etc.).
- Review key strategies and game plans with the team before the game starts.

During the Game

- Lead the team during the game by making strategic decisions based on the flow of the game.
- Ensure all players are contributing and encourage a positive, sportsmanlike attitude.
- Focus on player development even during the game – use opportunities to teach and guide.

Post-Game

- Provide feedback to the team – praise their efforts, highlight positives, and discuss areas of improvement.
- Keep communication open with parents/guardians and the Team Manager regarding any changes or plans.

My Hoops

- Download the My Hoops app from here for live scores and statistics, plus fixtures, ladders and results.

COMMUNICATION

Parent/Guardians Meetings

- At the beginning of the season with the Team Manager, hold a meeting (in-person or virtual) with parents/guardians to discuss expectations, team goals, and any important information.
- Provide your contact details and encourage parents/guardians to reach out if they have concerns or questions.

Regular Updates

- Keep parents/guardians and players informed of practice times, game schedules, and any changes to the calendar.
- Share progress updates, successes, and areas to focus on in future practices or games.

Feedback

- Encourage open feedback from players and parents/guardians on how the team is progressing and any areas for improvement.
- Create a positive environment where feedback is welcomed, constructive, and focuses on growth.

PLAYER DEVELOPMENT AND MOTIVATION

Individual Attention

- Take time to understand each player's strengths and areas for improvement.
- Tailor drills and feedback to suit the needs of individual players, fostering their development both as athletes and as people.
- Use the Player Journal to set and track goals.

Positive Reinforcement

- Always focus on what players are doing well and reinforce positive behaviour.
- Create an environment where players feel motivated, challenged, and confident to try new things.

Mental Toughness and Resilience

- Teach players how to handle both success and failure, emphasising effort and teamwork over individual achievements.
- Instil the values of resilience, perseverance, and good sportsmanship.

Tournaments

- Determine whether the team will enter tournaments and, with the Team Manager's assistance, arrange the team's participation. The Club provides financial support in accordance with the Club's Fee policy.

MANAGING DIFFICULT SITUATIONS

Player Issues

- Address any conflict or behavioural issues promptly, focusing on constructive solutions.
- Involve the Team Manager and parents/guardians if necessary to ensure the issue is resolved appropriately.

Parent/Guardian Concerns

- Listen to concerns from parents/guardians, keeping communication open and respectful.
- Stay focused on the team's goals and remind everyone that you're working to develop players both on and off the court.

Injury Management

- Always have the Team first-aid kit in the Coach kit and bring the kit to training and games.
- Ensure that you're familiar with any medical conditions or injuries of your players and have emergency contacts ready.
- If a player is injured, take the necessary steps for their care, in collaboration with the Team Manager and parents/guardians.
- Support the Team Manager in reporting any injuries requiring treatment by a health professional to the Club.

END OF SEASON RESPONSIBILITIES

Team Wrap-Up

- With the Team Manager host an end-of-season meeting or celebration to acknowledge the team's hard work and improvement if a Club-wide event is not scheduled.
- Share the team's achievements and any key moments that made the season memorable.

Player Recognition

- Work with the Team Manager to recognise players' efforts through awards or certificates.
- Encourage players to reflect on their personal progress and development.

Feedback and Reflection

- Gather feedback from players, parents/guardians, and the Team Manager on the season.
- Reflect on what worked well and areas for improvement, so you can continue to grow as a coach.

CLUB

Initiatives

- Sponsors – Our sponsors play a vital role in making basketball affordable – please show your appreciation by supporting their business and encourage your team to do so.
- Slam Dunk Bridging Fund – Direct families experiencing financial hardship to the Club Treasurer for a confidential discussion.
- Refereeing – Support players interested in refereeing and refer them to the Club Fees Policy for information on reimbursement options for related costs.
- Coaching – Formalise your experience or learn new skills by participating in Bendigo Basketball Association (BBA) coaching clinics. The Club provides financial assistance – refer to the Club Fees Policy for details.
- Other – Stay alert for new initiatives as they arise, and ensure you share the information with the team and participate when appropriate.

Resources

- The Club is developing resources for Players, Team Coaches and Team Managers you can find them on the website in the 'Team' section. You can also find more coaching resources at Basketball Victoria.

Compliance

- Ensure both you and the Team Manager have a valid Working with Children Check (WWCC). This is a requirement for all individuals working with children in the League.

Club Rules & Policies

- Operate within the Club Rules and Policies, including adherence to the Code of Conduct. This ensures that all interactions, both on and off the court, reflect the values and standards set by the Club. You can find the Club policies here.

Feedback

- Provide feedback to the Club regarding your experiences, challenges, and suggestions for improvement. As a Team Coach, your insights are valuable in helping us refine processes and enhance the overall experience for players, parents/guardians, and volunteers. Email hello@bendigophoenix.org.au.

By following these guidelines, you'll help maintain a safe, supportive, and respectful environment for everyone involved at Phoenix.

CONCLUSION

Being a Team Coach is an incredibly rewarding experience. By fostering a positive, supportive environment, you'll help players grow both as basketball players and individuals. Keep open lines of communication, stay organised, and always focus on the development of your players.

Good luck and thank you for your dedication to the team! Your role is integral in shaping the future of our young athletes and the success of Phoenix as an all-inclusive junior basketball club.